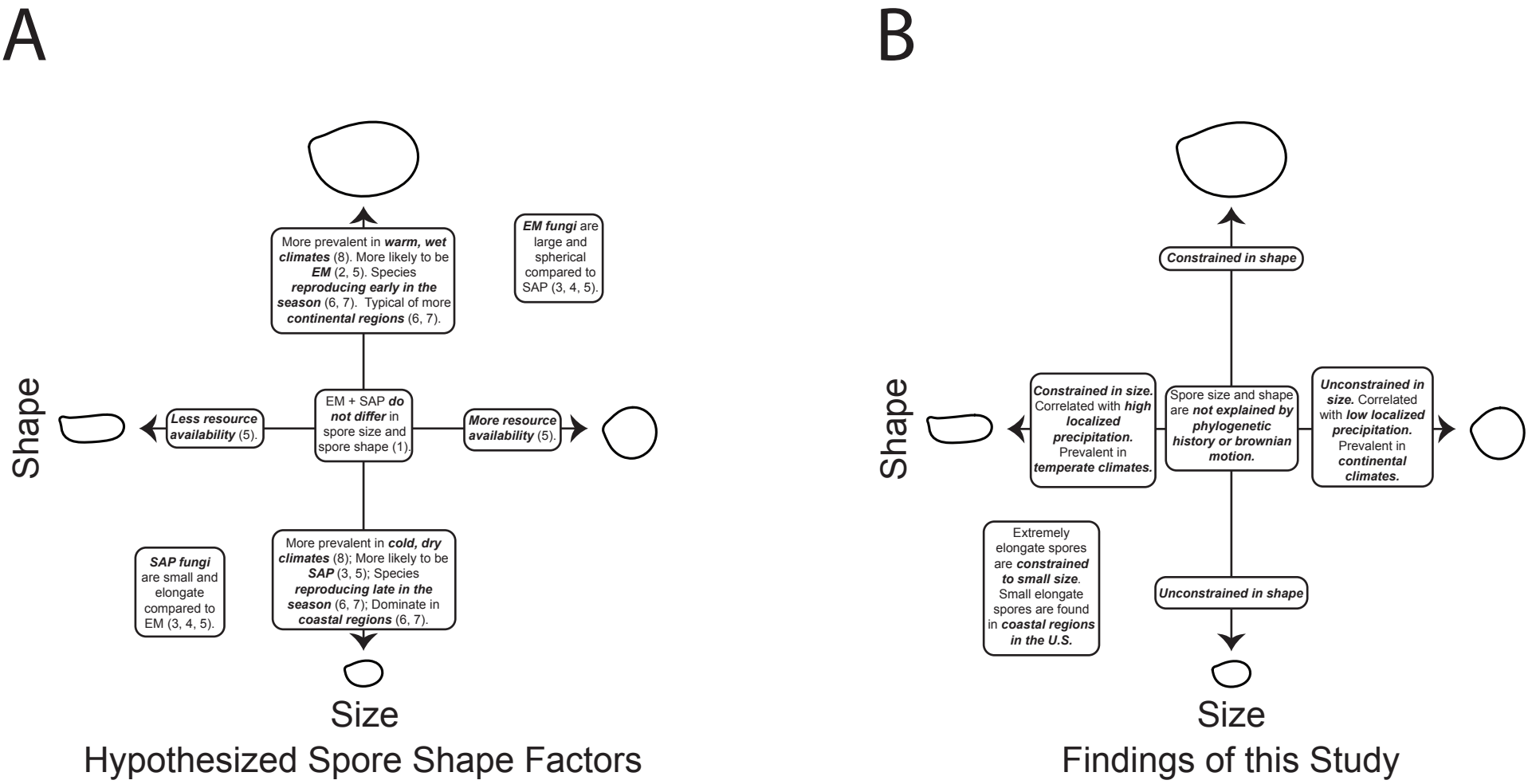


Figure 1. Comparison of hypotheses from the current literature on the factors influencing spore shape and the findings of this study. Spore shape, in *Amanita*, is simple, but what shapes spore shape is complex. *(*A) The factors influencing spore variation according to the literature. Based on the current literature, we identified disparate ecological factors as primary in determining spore shape and size. Some are contradictary. Ectomycorrhizal = EM; Saprotrophic = SAP. 1) Bassler et al. 2015; 2) Bassler et al. 2016; 3) Calhim et al. 2018; 4) Halbwachs et al. 2015; 5)Halbwachs et al. 2017; 6) Kauserud et al. 2008; 7) Kauserud et al. 2010 8) Pehim Limbu et al. 2025. (B) The significant correlates of spore variation in shape and size according to this study.